

John P. Freeman
Dr. Grow
CSC 378
4/14/2026

Smash The Rock

Link:

<https://thecode327.itch.io/smash-the-rock>

Story:

If I'm honest, the story of this game is mostly a joke. You're in a room with a goofy rock that's yelling at you, and you've got to smash it, it's not too much deeper than that. However, what I wanted to do was build up the world in a way that makes it feel fun and absurd as often as possible. Similarly to the Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy I suppose, which has a very simple linear story in the first book but that is fine because the focus is how goofy the setting is. Smash The Rock puts you in a giant room with a sadistic rock with googly eyes, a tapeworm, an angry goose, a slot machine, a kind old woman selling buckets of napalm, and Franklin. If I had more time I would flesh out the world building with hints in descriptions when you read every item, or the ability to ask the trader about things, but I quite simply didn't have the time to think about all that, much less write it out.

Achievements:

This game has a number of small features that I would call achievements. For one, I built a full buying and selling system with The Trader. This required a table that would keep track of the current stock and would delete lines as they were bought. Additionally, everything in the game has a value called 'Price' which dictates how much they are sold for. The longest achievement in terms of lines is definitely the attacking system by sheer number of words (nearly 500). It needs to keep track of multiple damage types, different messages for how damage is dealt, whether or not a weapon breaks, or whether the attack gives The Rock a Tapeworm. Other minor features I would call achievements is the coin keeping system, the multiple keys required for the Obsidian Chest, the haystack table, a slot machine, and a goose that steals your coins.

Feedback & Changes:

The two primary pieces of feedback I received was that the humor style was appreciated, and that there needed to be more to do. I think I accomplished both of these by adding lots of wacky and random things to find and do. I also added feedback such as

multiple attack responses for different kinds of weapons, easter eggs, and a reference to Dwayne Johnson.